



‘SMART CLASSES’ FOR SCHOOLS IN GODDA

Learning modules include tests, query sessions and feedback for Jharkhand students

Digital learning has transformed traditional classrooms and methods of teaching like never before. While classroom lessons remain the main source of learning for most children, online modules are playing an important part in covering course work on time and streamlining assessment processes. The growing importance of on-line teaching became clearer when schools and colleges were shut across the country for months because of the COVID-19 pandemic. At that time, online classes were the only way that students could be taught.

Even before the pandemic, the government had been laying stress on taking digital education to all rural parts of India. In line with that vision, Smart Classes were launched in Jharkhand's Godda district in 2018. So far, more than 60,000 students have benefited from the programme. Currently, 314 government schools in the district are covered under the initiative.

For 15-year-old Kamdev Kumar Sah, going to school every day was a struggle. His parents wanted him to study but the boy would often skip classes and play in the nearby fields, wander around and chat with villagers to while away time. “I did not think much about it until my Class 8 final exam results were out. I did not do well, and felt guilty because I knew how hard my parents had been working to support my education,” he said. Uncertain and anxious, Kamdev somehow managed to get admission at Damin High School, Rajabhita, in Class 9. Once there, he faced a big challenge – the school, the students, and the teachers – everything was new. “But my teachers were very supportive, and I started feeling better soon. The school had Smart Classes, which helped me a lot. To my surprise, it was for the first time that I was looking forward to going to school,”

said the teenager from Sundarpahari block in Lakkhipur village.

The Gyanodaya Godda initiative is run by the district administration and supported by the Adani Foundation. The audio-visual curriculum includes regular quizzes, analysis, and practice questions and it has been helping thousands of school students from

